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Analysis of the Atacama humanoid alien

Posted by: Antonio Huneus Apr 11, 2013 8 Comments 10908 Views

We posted earlier this week a story outlining the origin of the alleged tiny ET creature to be showcased in Dr. Steven Greer's *Sirius* documentary to be released later this month. We chronicled how this creature was none other than a case known in Chile as the La Noria ET from 2003; the name comes from a ghost town of the nitrate era in this part of Chile's northern Atacama Desert region. We left the story sort of in a cliff hanger as to what happened to it once it was acquired by a Spanish businessman from Barcelona.

We've discovered since a number of things, including the original 7 minute TV program about the case aired by Chile's Megavisión Channel V shortly after the creature's discovery was published in the local press. You can now see this program on YouTube in Spanish, and it shows exactly the location where the creature was discovered, as well as interviews with Oscar Mu oz, the man who found it, Alejandro D valos, the first one to photograph the being, and well known Chilean ufologist Rodrigo Fuenzalida, director of the AION UFO research group.

It's clear that this program was done in the early stages of the La Noria case, when the little being was owned by the pub owner from the provincial capital of Iquique. He didn't appear in the program because he probably wanted money to allow filming the creature (that was his *modus operandi* according to the newspaper *La Estrella de Arica*) and the TV channel didn't go along with it.

More importantly, we discovered who bought the creature and what happened once it left Chile and traveled to Spain, where it has remained ever since. It turns out that its owner is Ram n Navia-Osorio, a wealthy entrepreneur from Barcelona who runs the IIEE (Spanish acronym for Institute for Exobiological Investigation and Study), a UFO organization formed in 1975. Navia-Osorio was a member for many years prior to becoming the group's director. We found a very long report, "*El Ser Antropom rfico de Atacama*" (The Anthropomorphic Being from Atacama), written by Navia-Osorio himself and posted by Julio Gonz lez in "*Realidad OVNI*" (UFO Reality), a large UFO news website from Argentina specialized in cases from Latin America, just six days ago, on April 5, 2013.

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Navia-Osorio begins by recounting his trip to northern Chile ten years earlier, in late 2003, and how he met Oscar Muñoz in the ghost town of La Noria itself, and later Alejandro Dávalos, the young worker who took the first photos of the creature, and other people from the area. The contact between the Chilean and Spanish ufologists was Raúl Núñez Gálvez, a well known Chilean ufologist who lived in Spain for many years and was a member of the IIEE. He, too, traveled with Navia-Osorio to La Noria. The Spanish researcher provides initially some additional historical and paranormal details about this area with ghost towns from the booming nitrate industry of the late 19th century. One curious historical detail is that Charles Darwin, the famous father of the theory of evolution, visited La Noria in 1835. We also mentioned in our previous story that paranormal activities seem to be common in this area, and the Spanish researcher mentions this fact as well. He specifically claims that one of the things seen by the locals are ghostly apparitions of 19th century funeral processions, which then vanish.



The Spanish team in La Noria in 2003. (Credit: IIEE)

Navia-Osorio also provides the name of the Iquique pub owner, Ricardo Clotet, explaining that the original transaction with Oscar Muñoz took place through his brother, Ricardo Muñoz, who in turn contacted Clotet. The details of the transaction between Clotet and Navia-Osorio are not discussed, but the rumor in Chile was that it was a fairly substantial sum, probably tens of times higher than the paltry amount of less than \$100 that Clotet paid Muñoz. In any event, by 2004 the transaction took place and the creature was moved to Spain.

Inconclusive scientific backing

To his credit, Ramón Navia-Osorio made an earnest effort to have the creature analyzed by reputable scientists and medical doctors, although most of them seemed reluctant to get involved and specially to put their names in a signed report with conclusions. On July 5, 2004, the creature was presented to the Royal Academy of Sciences in Barcelona, where it was examined by several doctors, biologists and zoologists whose names are given in Navia-Osorio's report. He complains about the close-minded attitude of many of the scientists from the prestigious Complutense University in Madrid and other academic institutions. He claims that some of these professors would admit off-the-record that there was something truly unique and strange about the creature, but would refuse to state the same thing in a written report or even in an audio or video recording.

Navia-Osorio provides the text of two scientific documents in his report. The first one is the "radiological" report signed by doctors E. Feijoo, C. López and J. M. Colomer. It basically consists on a detailed description of the creature itself but it obviously avoids giving any conclusion about its origin. It is clear from this report, however, that the creature is not a crude hoax as was cavalierly suggested by a Complutense scientist who suggested (while remaining anonymous) that the whole thing was a hoax made with bird bones.

The second transcribed document is a forensic medical report written by Dr. Francisco Etxeberria Gabilondo, a professor of Legal and Forensic Medicine in the Basque Country University, and specialist in Forensic Anthropology with the Complutense University, who wrote the study at the bequest of the IIEE (probably for a fee, although that is not mentioned). Dr. Etxeberria wrote that, "it's a mummified body with all typical the characteristics of a fetus. The body has a length of 14 cm and displays all the structures and anatomical links normal for the head, trunk and extremities." He continues with a detailed description of each part of the body and finally gives his overall view:

"Taken as a whole, the proportions of the anatomical structures (skeleton and softer parts), the level of development of each one of its bones and its macroscopic configuration, allow us to interpret it without any shadow of doubt as a completely normal mummified fetus...Both based on the total length of the body as well as the length of the bones, it can be estimated that it's a fetus in an approximate gestation period close to 15 weeks."

The next question is how did this fetus, if that's what it is, showed up in the abandoned area near the old church of La Noria where it was found by Oscar Muñoz wrapped in a cloth. Obviously nobody knows but Dr. Etxeberria speculates that it could be a bit old but probably not an ancient mummified fetus. He explains that due to their lack of "bacterial flora in the digestive tube, which is where the putrefaction of corpses begin," and other factors, fetuses can be preserved quite well. To this we must add the environmental conditions



The Atacama humanoid's face.
(Credit: IIEE)



Atacama Alien Xray. (Credit: IIEE)

of the Atacama region, which is the driest desert on Earth, and is perfect for the preservation of objects of various kinds. In fact, the area near the city of Arica is famous for its 10,000-year old mummies far older than those from Egypt, but Dr. Ebeberria explains that it's unlikely to be very ancient, meaning by that hundreds of years.



Atacama humanoid's back. (Credit: IIEE)

The Greer connection

The final part of Ramón Navia-Osorio's long article describes briefly how Dr. Steven Greer became involved in this case. The link was made by Dr. Bravo, a female doctor from Dallas, who brought Dr. Greer to the IIEE office in Barcelona. The Spanish researcher mentions here some of the claims contained in the promotional material released by the producers of the *Sirius* documentary, including DNA sequencing which allegedly found the Atacama being had an "unknown classification." Until we see the film, we can't judge how valid is the scientific evidence presented.

That, in essence, is the saga of the little mummy from its early days in the Chilean ghost town to Spain's scientific labs. In his final conclusions, Navia-Osorio writes that, "we are not among those who claim that it's an ET, although morphologically speaking it really looks similar to some of them. We can't deny that, but before asserting it we must consider other possibilities. In summary, we don't have conclusive proof that can determine the nature of the specimen."

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ABOUT ANTONIO HUNEUS

Open Minds Investigative Reporter J. Antonio Huneus has covered the UFO field from an international perspective for over 30 years. His articles have appeared in dozens of publications in the U.S., Latin America, Europe and Japan. He was also the co-author of the Laurance Rockefeller-funded "UFO Briefing Document – The Best Available Evidence" and edited the book "A Study Guide to UFOs, Psychic & Paranormal Phenomena in the USSR." Huneus studied French at the Sorbonne University in Paris and Journalism at the University of Chile in Santiago in the 1970s. He has lectured at dozens of UFO Conferences all over the world and been interviewed by many media outlets including The Washington Post, the Sy-Fy and History Channels, Nippon-TV, etc. He received the "Ufologist of the Year" award at the National UFO Conference in Miami Beach in 1990 and the "Courage in Journalism" award at the X-Conference in Gaithersburg, Maryland, in 2007.



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8 COMMENTS

*akquaman*

April 11, 2013 at 7:12 pm

It is NOT a human fetus in any way! I just found some photos in Google of a 15 week human fetus (you can search them to look for yourself) and it definitely is NOTHING like it! Why PEOPLE is SO resistant to acknowledge that it can be in fact a little extraterrestrial? Because of it's small size? Why do they assume that they "should" have to be in any particular size? THAT is narrow thinking!

*Travis*

April 12, 2013 at 6:46 am

If the claim is true, the handling of this goes beyond science and more into the realm of Barnum and Bailey or Ripley's mermaid (Sewn Monkey) I say this because of the financial element. Everyone wants to "raise or earn money" from this discovery, where most scientific discoveries are usually laden with the desire to tell the truth allowing the money and offers to come ex post factum. They are doing entirely too much promotion and are somewhat invested in this project.

A discovery like this should be free to the world; I believe it is a total fabrication, allowing Greer and others the financial latitude they need to peruse their hobby on the greenbacks of others and avoiding the financial tab themselves.

There are a huge number of geneticists, biologists, astronomers etc that are legitimate, who would happily analyze the remains for free and would do so fairly and without bias, why scientific curiosity, but of course the cost that Greer and others ballyhoo is merely a Straw Man attempt to claim poverty in order to "get the truth out to the masses", which will once again be a big disappointment for others, double so for those who invested in the Sirius Project who pay for the adventures of others by merely telling lies.

Meanwhile the fetus that was once at peace is now being unceremoniously tossed about by untrained and unprofessional shysters looking for a payday are desecrating the remains of a poor soul who did not survive. People can be so insensitive and stupid and have no trouble lying, it is sickening. People like Greer may truly believe in UFOs; I personally believe the Universe is teaming with life, but when Greer and others set up these staged hoaxes to further their case, it only pushes the real evidence away.

We have reached the point where we can no longer separate the truth from the lie and it is people like Greer and others who are responsible for damning us from finding the truth in a responsible way.

*The Sirius Film*

April 12, 2013 at 8:07 am

Thanks Antonio! That is the most comprehensive article we've seen to date. Through your amazing work and our extraordinary claims, we will require a plethora of extraordinary evidence. -- "Planet earth has been and is being visited by highly evolved intelligent beings that are not from this world." For breaking updates on 'Sirius' and to learn the implications of extraterrestrial life, new energy systems and how it will all affect you, follow The Sirius Film on Twitter @TheSiriusFilm

*Zen Benefiel*

April 12, 2013 at 11:51 am

Excellent article, first of all. Antonio's tenacity to expose clear details and a scientific approach is quite refreshing in the field of Ufology. I've known Antonio for a number of years and find his approach to be of integrity, not only personally but to the disclosure of facts and not conjecture. He's thorough and remains open to new information without prejudice. This field is full of challenges, like life itself, and it's nice to witness this kind of reporting. My sincerest gratitude.

I'm sure we all wish that this would be demonstrable evidence, but given the circumstances and location it would seem more like the efforts of a mother or family member to offer solace to an aborted fetus. Mummification in such an arid environment could/would indeed cause noticeable differences between a photo and the real thing over time. It also seems logical that pressure from being buried would affect the soft tissue to the extent of appearing misshapen.

I have to say I've been concerned about Greer's activity since meeting him in person in 1997. He's done some great things and moved people to action, but there is something that just seems out of synch somehow. Maybe it is his arrogance and self-important display with body guards that rubs me the wrong way, especially when no one else in the field travels with such showmanship.

I'm reminded of one who will go to extremes, even at the risk of damage to legitimate others, to get a point across -- real or not. Truth will emerge in time, no doubt. I just have to acknowledge I'm sensing something amiss. Sharing that is a risk I'll take gladly. I don't have a problem being wrong... and hope that I am. Thanks again, Antonio.

*patrick shaw*

April 12, 2013 at 3:33 pm

Bravo Travis, I agree. It is absurd how "shysters" do nothing but muddy the waters for personal gain. A scientific approach, as you point out, would simplify and clarify things once and for all.

Micah Hanks



April 12, 2013 at 3:48 pm

Excellent work as always, Antonio. Somewhat mirroring the final views expressed by Navia-Osorio, we must also remember that, even if the mummy in question were to be found to be anything other than a human, this alone would not prove its extraterrestrial origin. Then again, on the remote possibility that it were found conclusively to be non-human, but terrestrial, this too would be of great interest... why the "extraterrestrial" meme is so often appended to stories of this nature is both baffling, and highly revelatory in terms of showing the bias many will enter ufological studies fully armed with!

Once again, you guys have presented a very reasonable survey, based on what the evidence will allow us to understand of the specimen at present... and now, I will calmly await those portions of the UFO community that will damn us for being "skeptics" in stating the obvious truth: there is no conclusive proof of "extraterrestrials" offered by the Atacama Mummy.



Mark Fritz

April 13, 2013 at 3:01 am

These scientists had better get their "story" straight before the movie comes out, because all bets are off after that. You watch how readily those that are reluctant to make a comment now, once they discover the popularity of this incredible evidence, will so eagerly agree to make a comment, for a fee of course.



Alejandro Rojas

April 13, 2013 at 8:21 am

I agree Micah. In the best case it remains as an unclassified species and is a cryptozoological oddity.

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